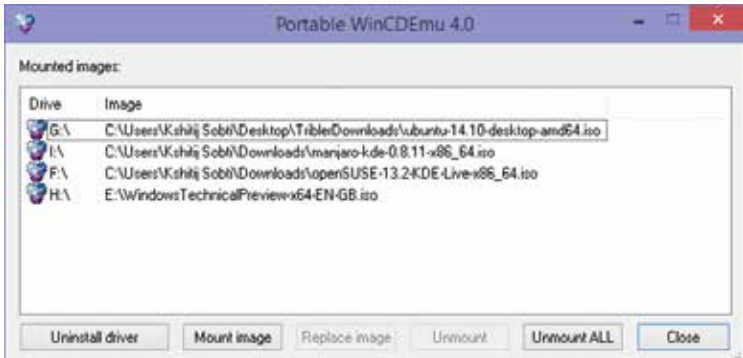


Now this sounds quite dodgy doesn't it? It's probably just the kind of thing pirates are looking for. You are not wrong. Such software and such methods are widely used in piracy.

However, the use of a technology in committing crime does not mean it is without legitimate value. After all, do you want the life of your purchased software or game to be limited by the life of the fragile piece of plastic it came in? What happens if you lose the disk or damage it? You might be able to ask for a replacement, but even so, till when? Will they offer a replacement a decade later? Is it not also wrong to lock software you sell to others using a such a fragile key that might not be replaceable.

You probably know the answer to the above questions. So you can probably also realise how useful such software would be in backing up and preserving software you legally purchased. If you are looking for such



WinCDEmu comes in a portable version that doesn't need installation.

software, DAEMON Tools and Alcohol 120% are your best bet, although they don't offer these advanced features in the free versions of their software.

Of course if you don't need it for those reasons, simple disk emulation software are available for free. Even those that support other file formats. Firstly there is the brilliant, free and open source tool called WinCDEmu that supports numerous image formats.

OSX and Linux can natively mount .iso files without additional software. On OSX you can simply double click an iso file to mount it, but Linux needs a command or two typed in the terminal. If you're looking to mount files other than the standard .iso, you can use AcetoneISO, ToastMount, or Silicon Empire on Linux. ToastMount also runs on OSX.